Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-15

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 26:1-19

1 Concerning the divisions of the gatekeepers: of the Korahites, Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph.

2 And the sons of Meshelemiah were Zechariah the firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth,

3 Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, Eliehoenai the seventh.

4 Moreover the sons of Obed-Edom were Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, Sacar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth,

5 Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peulthai the eighth; for God blessed him.

6 Also to Shemaiah his son were sons born who governed their fathers' houses, because they were men of great ability.

7 The sons of Shemaiah were Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad, whose brothers Elihu and Semachiah were able men.

8 All these were of the sons of Obed-Edom, they and their sons and their brethren, able men with strength for the work: sixty-two of Obed-Edom.

9 And Meshelemiah had sons and brethren, eighteen able men.

10 Also Hosah, of the children of Merari, had sons: Shimri the first (for though he was not the firstborn, his father made him the first),

11 Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, Zechariah the fourth; all the sons and brethren of Hosah were thirteen.

12 Among these were the divisions of the gatekeepers, among the chief men, having duties just like their brethren, to serve in the house of the Lord.

13 And they cast lots for each gate, the small as well as the great, according to their father's house.

14 The lot for the East Gate fell to Shelemiah. Then they cast lots for his son Zechariah, a wise counselor, and his lot came out for the North Gate;

15 to Obed-Edom the South Gate, and to his sons the storehouse.

16 To Shuppim and Hosah the lot came out for the West Gate, with the Shallecheth Gate on the ascending highway—watchman opposite watchman.

17 On the east were six Levites, on the north four each day, on the south four each day, and for the storehouse two by two.

18 As for the Parbar on the west, there were four on the highway and two at the Parbar.

19 These were the divisions of the gatekeepers among the sons of Korah and among the sons of Merari.

II. Key Summary

• The passage lists three families of gatekeepers: Meshelemiah of the Korahites (18 sons and brethren), Obed-Edom (62 descendants), and Hosah of the Merarites (13 in all). They are described as "men of great ability" and "able men with strength for the work."

• These chief gatekeepers had duties just like their brethren, to serve in the house of the Lord; they cast lots for each gate, "the small as well as the great," according to their father's house.

• Shelemiah drew the East Gate; his son Zechariah, "a wise counselor," the North Gate; Obed-Edom the South Gate and his sons the storehouse; Shuppim and Hosah the West Gate. Each day there were six Levites on the east, four on the north, four on the south, two by two at the storehouse, four on the highway and two at the Parbar.

III. Passage Analysis

Guarding the Gate Protects God's House and People

> The gatekeepers had to protect the temple from intrusion, and also protect the Israelites from wandering into the temple and being struck by God (Numbers 3:10). [1]

The passage assigns people to every spot: six on the east, four on the north, four on the south, plus the storehouse, the highway, and the Parbar (vv. 17–18). The people at the

gates were guarding God's house, and they were also protecting everyone who came to it.

Guarding the Gate Takes Strength and Wisdom

> There were porters appointed to attend the temple, who guarded all the avenues that led to it, opened and shut all the outer gates and attended at them, not only for the state, but for service, to direct and instruct those who were going to worship in the courts of the sanctuary in the decorum they were to observe, to encourage those that were timorous, to send back the strangers and unclean, and to guard against thieves and others that were enemies to the house of God. [2]

Gatekeepers had to stop some people, and also guide and encourage others. That is why the passage calls them "men of great ability" and "able men with strength for the work," and calls Zechariah "a wise counselor" (vv. 6, 8, 14). The job needed strength, and it needed wisdom.

IV. Reflection Question

Gatekeepers stopped people from wandering into the temple by mistake. If you saw a friend about to walk into something that would hurt them, what would you do?

The gatekeepers stood at the gates to guard God's house and to protect the Israelites from wandering in and being struck [1]. And "happy are those who dwell in God's house... they are well guarded": men attended at the gates of the temple, but angels attend at the gates of the New Jerusalem (Revelation 21:12) [2].

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 《歷代志上聖經綜合解讀》(1 Chronicles Comprehensive Commentary), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT26.htm

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible, 1 Chronicles 26, https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_026.cfm